

Pavel Rysych

Head of Design | Product Design Leader

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SUMMARY

Product design leader with 9+ years in fintech, identity verification, nonprofit SaaS and consumer products, from founding designer to Head of Design. Connects customer strategy, product design and business metrics: at Admirals, customer journey improvements contributed to a 67% lower customer acquisition cost, and the web redesign tripled click-through rate. Leads AI adoption hands-on: reorganized web production around designers working with Claude, ran an AI-assisted design system audit, and designed and built a live AI-powered product solo.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Design, Admirals | Feb 2024 - Present

Global online trading broker: CFDs, stocks and ETFs, MetaTrader platforms.

- Helped shape an audience strategy focused on experienced traders and led the redesign of the web experience around it: value proposition, information architecture, content hierarchy and customer journeys.
- Customer journey improvements contributed to a 67% reduction in customer acquisition cost (CAC), a 16% increase in first-time deposits and an 11% lift in conversion.
- Tripled click-through rate with the web redesign; a single targeted UI change added EUR 400K in monthly revenue.
- Redesigned Sign Up from a single screen into a seven-step flow, increasing conversion into registration by 7%.
- Helped introduce Client Business Value (CBV) as an acquisition metric and omnichannel analytics to measure client quality and each channel's contribution, part of a retention and unit economics focus that cut annual losses from EUR 10M to EUR 1.6M.
- Restructured the design team around senior designers who own decisions and execution; made user research, behavioral analytics and experimentation part of how work is prioritized.
- Reorganized web production from a six-developer workflow to two designers using Claude plus one developer, with Claude configured on marketing strategy, design direction and brand guidelines.
- Led an AI-assisted audit of legacy product and web UI; documented components, semantic tokens and interaction states, and used Figma MCP to check implementation against the design system.
- Built working prototypes in Lovable and a creative compliance checker for marketing review; ran internal AI workshops and brought AI-assisted workflows into email production in Bloomreach.

Founder and Product Designer, Subskim | Jun 2026 - Present

Independent product, live at subskim.com: subscription tracker and renewal calendar.

- Conceived, designed and built the product solo, end to end, using AI for implementation.
- Designed AI-assisted screenshot import: the model extracts subscription details from an image, and the person reviews and confirms them before saving, so incomplete or misread data never enters the list unchecked.
- Designed the renewal calendar, spending overview and monthly review that turn a one-time import into an ongoing habit.

Head of Product Design, Mechanism Ventures | Sep 2021 - Oct 2023

Venture studio that builds and operates consumer businesses; portfolio revenue of \$300M+.

- Led product design for four portfolio companies at different stages: Pettable (emotional support animal letters), Learner (online tutoring), Top Nutrition Coaching (dietitian coaching) and PrimePutt (golf training products).
- Designed MVPs, onboarding flows and improvements to live customer journeys, starting from the decision each customer needed to make next.
- Increased onboarding conversion at Pettable by 28% within three months.
- Reduced user churn by 18% through leave-intent interventions.

Head of Design, MetaMap (formerly Mati) | Dec 2018 - Sep 2021

Identity verification (KYC) platform for businesses, later acquired by Incode; raised \$70M during this period.

- Led design through a product pivot that expanded the verification offering from 2 to 15+ checks, keeping configurable verification workflows clear for businesses and their end users.
- Led design within a product and delivery team of five designers and twelve developers.
- Moved the design process to Figma, built reusable patterns for journeys and states, and brought product analytics into product decisions.

Founding Designer, Fundraise Up | Sep 2017 - Dec 2018

Online donation platform for nonprofits, used by UNICEF USA; has since grown from 12 to 350+ people.

- Turned the one-question-at-a-time concept into a compact donation checkout that replaced long donation forms on nonprofit websites.
- Increased donation conversion 2.8x with a gamified, step-by-step experience; donor satisfaction of about 98% CSAT.
- Designed monthly giving prompts with adaptive suggested amounts, animated payment feedback and a mobile-first flow, increasing conversion to recurring donations.
- Designed the nonprofit admin campaign overview, plus early pitch and marketing materials.

SKILLS

Leadership: design strategy, design team leadership, team structure and ownership, design operations, cross-functional collaboration with product, engineering and marketing, workshops and coaching.

Product design: end-to-end product design, UX and UI design, interaction design, information architecture, customer journeys, onboarding, conversion optimization, growth design, design systems (components, semantic tokens, interaction states), prototyping, responsive and mobile web.

Research and data: user research, behavioral analytics, experimentation and A/B testing, funnel analysis, omnichannel attribution, metric design.

AI: AI-assisted design and development workflows, context engineering for LLMs, AI product design with human review, Claude, Codex, Figma MCP, Lovable.

Tools: Figma, Claude, Codex, Lovable, Bloomreach.

Industries: fintech and online trading, identity verification (KYC), nonprofit fundraising, B2B SaaS, consumer subscription apps, venture studio.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's degree in Design, Saint Petersburg State University | 2017

LANGUAGES

English (professional), Russian (native)